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Go-Live Plan

Child-owned, founder-controlled: an anonymous Wyoming IP holdco, a separate management company for banking & taxes, the full legal & equity agreement set, and a guerrilla GTM.

ARGUS FINANCIAL PARTNERS · CONFIDENTIAL — FOUNDER · **JUNE 22, 2026**

> Strategic guidance only — not legal, financial, tax, or investment advice. Securities, money-transmission, and corporate-formation decisions must be reviewed by licensed counsel and a CPA before you act. Sections flagged "⚖ see counsel" are where this matters most.

Contents

Go-Live Plan — Child-Owned, Founder-Controlled, with a Guerrilla GTM

The operator's plan for taking Argus Financial Partners live under a specific ownership design: **your adult child owns the company anonymously, you control it and earn through a separate management company you own, and you grow it with a low-budget guerrilla marketing engine** — all inside the Phase-A non-custodial posture and the "never call it a bank" guardrail.

> **How to read this.** This document *layers on top of* — it does not replace — three existing docs: `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` (the Wyoming-LLC → Delaware-C-corp ramp + the Phase A/B/C compliance ladder), `LAUNCH.md` (the launch readiness / go-no-go gate), and `PRODUCTION-STRATEGY.md` (cloud, ops, GTM positioning). Where those cover something, this cross-references rather than repeats. Every section is tagged **DO NOW**, **DEFER → Phase B/C**, or ⚖ **see counsel**, matching the house style. Dollar/time figures are 2025–2026 planning estimates, not quotes.

> ⚖ **This is strategy, not legal or tax advice.** Gifting a company to your child, the management-company structure, the anonymity layering, and the equity grants each carry **gift-tax, valuation, asset-protection, securities, and control** consequences. **A fintech/securities attorney and a CPA must review this before you file, sign, or transfer anything.** Treat every ⚖ tag as a hard stop until counsel signs off. Gift-tax exemption and exclusion amounts *change every year* — this doc describes the **mechanics**, not the current-year numbers; your CPA supplies those.

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1 1. Executive summary & the ownership thesis

You want three things at once that normally pull against each other: (a) your **child to own** the company, (b) **you to keep control** and have a clean way to **bank and pay taxes**, and (c) the ownership to be **anonymous**. The clean way to get all three is a **two-entity split**, formed on day one and built to survive the future Delaware C-corp conversion:

```
      You (founder)                                Your adult child
             │ owns 100%                                 │ owns 100% (anonymously)
             ▼                                           ▼
   ┌────────────────────────┐   Management   ┌────────────────────────────────┐
   │  Argus Management LLC  │ Services Agr.  │  Argus Financial Partners LLC  │
   │  (your home state)     │ ─────────────▶ │  (Wyoming, manager–managed)    │
   │  • you bank here       │  fee for svc   │  • owns ALL IP + brand + code  │
   │  • you draw income     │ ◀───────────── │  • the appreciating asset      │
   │  • you file taxes here │   the asset    │  • YOU are the named manager   │
   │  • you control it      │   stays put    │    → control without ownership │
   └────────────────────────┘                └────────────────────────────────┘
```

The thesis — "freeze the value to the child now; keep control and income via the management company."

- The valuable, appreciating asset is the **IP**: the code in this repo, the architecture, the brand, the domains. It lives in the **IP HoldCo** (`Argus Financial Partners LLC`, Wyoming), which your child owns 100%. Because the gift happens **now, pre-revenue**, the company is worth very little — the **most tax-efficient moment** to move ownership and future appreciation into your child's hands. ⚖
- **Ownership ≠ control.** A Wyoming LLC can be **manager-managed**: you are appointed **manager** in the operating agreement and run everything and sign for the company, while your child is the passive **member/owner**. You don't need to own it to control it.
- The **Management Company** (`Argus Management LLC`) is owned by **you**. It contracts with the IP HoldCo under a **Management Services Agreement** and is paid a fee. This is the entity where **you open bank accounts, draw income, and file taxes** — and it owns no IP and does no regulated activity, so it carries no appreciating value and no licensing exposure.
- **Anonymity** comes from Wyoming (members are not on the public record) plus a manager-managed filing and a registered agent, optionally hardened with a holding-LLC/trust layer (§2.3).

This is a recognized estate-planning / asset-protection pattern. Its sharp edges — gift-tax valuation, keeping the management fee defensible to the IRS, and not piercing the liability shield by commingling — are exactly the things §4, §3, and §9 flag for counsel.

Decisions baked in (from your direction): child is an **adult (18+)** → can hold units and sign directly, **no trust/custodian required** (a trust is offered only as an optional anonymity wrapper); your entity is a **management company you own**; **maximum anonymity**; equity grants are scoped for **future hires, advisors, and a co-founder**.

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2 2. Entity 1 — the IP HoldCo (`Argus Financial Partners LLC`, Wyoming)

DO NOW. This is the same Wyoming LLC that `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §2 recommends — the lowest-cost, most private, most crypto-forward US entity — with two modifications for your design: it is **manager-managed** (you as manager) and **owned by your child** (not you).

2.1 Formation & governance

- **Articles of Organization** filed in Wyoming, **manager-managed**, naming only the **registered agent** publicly (~$50–125/yr; Wyoming Agents / Northwest / etc.).
- **Operating Agreement (manager-managed):** names **you as manager** with full operating authority (sign contracts, open the company's own operational accounts, hire, execute the IP assignment), and your **child as the sole member/owner**. This private document — not the state filing — is where ownership is recorded. It also contains the **admission rules** for later equity grants and the conversion mechanics (§6, §2.4).
- **EIN** from the IRS (free; a single-member LLC still gets its own EIN).
- **All IP assigned *into* this entity** (§5) — this is the box that must own the code, so that when your child receives the company, they receive the IP with it.

2.2 Why the asset lives here

This entity holds the thing that appreciates. Putting it in the child's hands **while it's worth almost nothing** is the whole tax play (§4). Everything regulated-but-deferred (Phase B/C: partner bank, MSB, licensing) eventually sits in *subsidiaries of this entity's successor*, never in your management company — see the holdco/opco split in `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §2.2.

2.3 Anonymity mechanics (maximum) ⚖

- **Baseline (free):** Wyoming does not list LLC members publicly. Manager-managed means the public filing shows the registered agent and (optionally) the manager — **never the member/owner**. Your child's name appears only in the private operating agreement.
- **Optional hardening:** have your child hold their membership through **their own Wyoming holding LLC** or a **trust**, so even the manager/organizer line doesn't tie to a personal name, and use the registered agent as the organizer of record. A trust also adds asset-protection and a clean succession path. This is optional because your child is an adult; weigh it against the extra admin. ⚖

- **Honest limit:** anonymity is *privacy from casual public record*, not from the IRS, a bank's beneficial-ownership (KYC/BOI) process, or a court order. Banks and any future investor **will** see the real owner. Don't design around hiding from regulators — design around keeping it off the public internet. The "anonymity vs. fundability" tension resurfaces at the C-corp conversion (§9 risk register).

2.4 How it converts later (DEFER → Phase B/C)

When you raise or stand up a regulated subsidiary, convert the IP HoldCo to a **Delaware C-corp** (`Argus Financial Partners, Inc.`) per `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §2.2: the child's units become **founder stock**, profits interests convert to an **ISO/NSO option pool** (§6), and the holdco/opco split insulates licenses from the IP. Papering the operating agreement cleanly now makes that conversion tax-neutral and cheap. **Don't pay for any of this today.** ⚖

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3 3. Entity 2 — the Management Company (`Argus Management LLC`)

DO NOW. This is the entity you asked for — *your* vehicle for **taxes and bank accounts**.

3.1 What it is

- A **second LLC, owned 100% by you**, formed in **your home state** (where you actually work — no need for Wyoming here; you want it local and simple for banking and taxes). Single-member → disregarded for federal tax, so its income flows to your personal return.
- It is the entity where **you open the operating bank account** (Mercury or Brex — see `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §7), **draw your income**, and **file your taxes**.
- It **owns no IP and does no regulated activity.** That keeps it value-light (so it's not part of the estate you're freezing) and license-free.

3.2 The Management Services Agreement (the connective tissue) ⚖

A written **Management Services Agreement (MSA)** between `Argus Management LLC` (provider) and `Argus Financial Partners LLC` (client):

- **Scope:** software development, product management, operations, marketing, and administration performed by you/your company **for** the IP HoldCo.
- **Fee:** a **defensible, arm's-length** fee (cost-plus or a market rate for the services) — this is the income you live on. ⚖ The fee must be *reasonable and documented*; an inflated or arbitrary fee invites the IRS to recharacterize it and can undercut both entities. Your CPA sets the basis.

- **IP stays put:** the MSA states explicitly that **all work product and IP belongs to the IP HoldCo** (reinforced by the contributor IP-assignment in §5) — the management company is paid for services and never accrues ownership of the asset.
- **Formalities:** keep the two entities' books and bank accounts **fully separate** (no commingling), invoice on a regular cadence, and observe the agreement in practice. This is what makes the structure respected rather than ignored. ⚖

3.3 Why this gives you what you asked for

You said you want "a separate LLC that gives me some way to do taxes, set up bank accounts, etc." This is it: **you bank and pay taxes through a company you own outright**, you draw a real income via the MSA, and yet **the appreciating asset and its future upside sit with your child** in the other entity. Control (via the manager role) and income (via the MSA) are decoupled from ownership.

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4 4. The gift / ownership transfer to your child ⚖ (heaviest counsel + CPA flag)

This is the step that makes your child the owner. Because they're an adult, it's mechanically simple — but the **tax treatment is the part to get right with a CPA before you sign.**

- **The instrument:** an **Assignment of Membership Interest / Gift Agreement** transferring 100% of `Argus Financial Partners LLC` to your child, recorded in the operating agreement's member schedule. Document **donative intent** (it's a gift, not a sale).
- **Do it pre-revenue, at low valuation.** The earlier and emptier the company, the lower the gift's value, the less of your lifetime exemption it consumes, and the more future appreciation lands **outside your estate** in your child's hands. This timing is the entire tax advantage — **gift before the company has measurable value.** ⚖
- **Form 709 + valuation.** A gift above the annual exclusion generally requires you to file a **federal gift-tax return (Form 709)** and apply your lifetime exemption (usually no tax *due*, but a filing). Support the reported value with a **defensible valuation memo** (a pre-revenue software entity is low, but show the work). Your CPA decides whether a formal appraisal is warranted. ⚖
- **Basis:** a gift generally carries over **your cost basis** to your child (unlike an inheritance's step-up) — your CPA will weigh this against the estate-freeze benefit. ⚖

- **No trust/custodian needed (adult child).** Because your child is 18+, they can own and sign directly. A **trust or a child-owned holding LLC** remains an *optional* wrapper purely for **anonymity (§2.3) and asset protection** — not a requirement. ⚖
- **Sequencing matters: assign the IP into the HoldCo *before* you gift the HoldCo** (§5 → §4), so your child receives the entity *with the IP already in it*. Gifting an empty shell and assigning IP afterward muddies who owned the IP at transfer.

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5 5. The complete legal & corporate agreement set

The full paper trail you asked to have "completed." Tagged by timing; ⚖ = do not sign without counsel. Items already detailed elsewhere are cross-referenced, not rewritten.

#	Document	Entity	Who signs	When	Purpose
1	**Articles of Organization**	IP HoldCo (WY) + Mgmt Co (home state)	Organizer / registered agent	DO NOW	Forms each LLC; only the agent is public
2	**Operating Agreement — manager-managed**	IP HoldCo	You (mgr) + child (member)	DO NOW	Ownership, your control as manager, admission rules for §6 grants, conversion mechanics
3	**Operating Agreement**	Mgmt Co	You (sole member/mgr)	DO NOW	Your wholly-owned services vehicle
4	**EIN** (each entity)	Both	You	DO NOW	Gates each bank account
5	**IP / Technology Assignment** (you → IP HoldCo)	IP HoldCo	You	DO NOW ⚖	Moves all repo code/designs/marks/domains into the HoldCo — the #1 diligence item (`CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §5). **Before the gift (§4).**
6	**Membership-Interest Assignment / Gift Agreement** (you → child)	IP HoldCo	You + child	DO NOW ⚖	Transfers 100% ownership to your child (§4)
7	**Form 709 + valuation memo**	— (your personal filing)	You (CPA-prepared)	DO NOW ⚖	Reports the gift; applies lifetime exemption (§4)
8	**Management Services Agreement**	Mgmt Co ↔ IP HoldCo	You (both sides)	DO NOW ⚖	Your income + the IP-stays-put + arm's-length-fee terms (§3.2)
9	**Member/Manager Consent Resolutions**	Both	You (mgr) + child (member)	DO NOW	Authorize the bank accounts, the IP assignment, the gift, the MSA
10	**Contributor / Contractor IP-**	IP HoldCo	Any contributor	DO NOW	Anyone who ever touches the code assigns it to the HoldCo

#	Document	Entity	Who signs	When	Purpose
	Assignment + NDA template				(work-for-hire alone is insufficient)
11	**ToS / Privacy / E-Sign / risk + "not advice" disclaimers**	IP HoldCo	— (publish)	DO NOW	Cross-ref `LAUNCH.md` §5; publish before any signup
12	**AML/KYC/BSA policy + named compliance officer + OFAC screening**	IP HoldCo	You (officer)	DO NOW	Cross-ref `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §8; the identity ladder + VC + append-only audit are ~70% of the evidence layer already
13	**Trademark application** (Argus brand)	IP HoldCo	You	Soon	USPTO knockout search + file; marks company-owned via #5
14	**Beneficial Ownership (BOI) status check**	Both	You	DO NOW ⚖	FinCEN BOI rules have shifted; confirm current applicability for each entity
15	**Equity Incentive Framework** (profits-interest plan + pool)	IP HoldCo	You (mgr)	DO NOW	§6 — set up the framework even before the first grant

> Items 11–13 and the Phase-A compliance posture are the same gate `LAUNCH.md` §5 already enforces — this plan just adds the **two-entity, gift, and MSA** rows (2–9) on top.

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6 6. Equity & stock-option framework (future hires · advisors · co-founder)

You asked that "stock options" be completed. In an LLC there is no stock yet — the correct analog is **profits interests** — so the framework is two-stage, matching the LLC → C-corp ramp (`CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §4).

6.1 Now (LLC stage) — profits interests

- Adopt an **Equity Incentive Framework** and **reserve a pool** (e.g., **10–15%** of fully-diluted interests) for grants. Grants are **profits interests** — a share of *future* upside only (not existing value), which is the tax-efficient LLC instrument when papered correctly. ⚖
- **83(b) election within 30 days** of any grant subject to vesting — for *every* recipient (co-founder, advisor, hire). Missing the 30-day window is **unfixable.** Put it on a checklist. ⚖
- **Child-owner interaction:** every grant **dilutes the child's 100%** per the operating agreement's admission rules (§2.1). Reserve the pool **up front** so dilution is planned, disclosed, and clean — not a surprise to the owner. The operating agreement should pre-authorize the manager to issue from the reserved pool.

6.2 The three recipient types

- **Co-founder / partner:** an equity split with **vesting + a 1-year cliff** (standard 4-year vest) and **83(b) within 30 days**. ⚠ Admitting a member **converts the single-member LLC tax treatment to a partnership** — this is a real trigger to consider **doing the Delaware C-corp conversion early** (`CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §4) so you grant clean options instead. Decide co-founder timing with that in mind. ⚖
- **Advisors:** a standard **advisor agreement** (e.g., FAST-style) + a small profits-interest/option grant on a **1–2 year vest, no cliff**, sized by advisor tier.
- **Future hires / employees:** grant profits interests from the reserved pool now; these become **ISO/NSO options** at conversion (§6.3).

6.3 At the C-corp conversion (DEFER)

Profits interests convert to a normal **ISO/NSO option pool** under a Delaware **Equity Incentive Plan**; the child's units become founder stock; adopt **Carta/Pulley** to manage the cap table (overkill for the LLC, right at conversion). This is the moment "stock options" in the literal sense exist. ⚖

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7 7. Guerrilla marketing plan — X, Instagram & beyond

The growth engine: maximum reach, minimum budget — operating **strictly inside** the `LAUNCH.md` §1 compliance guardrail. The product's genuine novelty (an **AI agent that moves your money under cryptographic, scoped, revocable permission + tokenized real-world assets in a non-custodial wallet**) is the wedge (`PRODUCTION-STRATEGY.md` §8).

7.1 Positioning & the compliance vocabulary gate ⚠

- **Narrative:** "*the first money app run by AI agents — that you actually control.*" Lead with the agent + MCP + tokenized-RWA story, not feature parity with a bank.
- **Say:** "tokenized assets," "non-custodial wallet," "agentic finance," "you hold the keys," "scoped, revocable permission."
- **Never say:** "bank," "banking," "your bank," "deposits," "FDIC," "bank account," or any investment-return promise. Every investment surface carries the "not advice / not an offering" disclaimer the product already models. **Every post, caption, and clip passes this gate before it ships.**

7.2 X (Twitter) — the primary build-in-public channel

- **Founder build-in-public cadence:** a recurring ship-log of the agent/MCP/DID/VC tech — real progress, real demos. Developer-credible content earns the early AI + crypto crowd.
- **Demo clips:** short screen-recordings of the wedge — "*watch an AI agent move money under a 90-second permission it can't exceed*" — the single most shareable moment the product has.
- **Reply strategy:** thoughtful, value-first replies into AI-agent, MCP, crypto, and fintech timelines; engage the MCP/agent-dev community where the product is genuinely a platform they could build on.
- **Waitlist drops:** periodic invite waves to manufacture scarcity and control onboarding risk.

7.3 Instagram / Reels (+ TikTok) — the visual demo channel

- **Reels:** the same demo moments cut for vertical video — the agent permission flow, the tokenized asset UI, the Quiet-Premium design aesthetic. Visual, fast, looped.
- **Founder story:** a tasteful "*why I built this and put it in my kid's name*" angle — the ownership design itself is a differentiated, human story (handle with care; keep your child's privacy intact, consistent with §2.3).
- **Design-led brand clips:** lean on the monochrome + jade Quiet-Premium look as a recognizable visual signature.

7.4 Other low-cost / guerrilla channels

- **Invite-only waitlist + referral mechanics:** scarcity + a referral coefficient is the core growth loop; it also throttles onboarding risk in Phase A.
- **Build-in-public beyond X:** a public changelog, **Hacker News** / **dev.to** posts on the agent/MCP/DID tech, and a **Product Hunt** launch when the portal is demo-ready.
- **Communities:** value-first participation in crypto/AI **Discords** and relevant **Reddit** subs — contribute, don't spam.

- **Short YouTube explainers:** "how the agent actually works" — the credibility long-form.
- **Guerrilla tactics (zero/low budget):** light, defensible hot takes on "agentic finance," meme-able demo moments, cross-promo with AI-tool creators, and **stunt demos** (an AI agent doing something legitimately novel, on camera). Tie the **teen/family angle** to the Phase-22 *Argus Starter* product for a distinct audience.

7.5 Cadence, funnel & metrics

Channel	Cadence	Primary asset
X	3–5×/week + daily replies	Ship-log, demo clips, waitlist drops
Instagram/TikTok	2–3 Reels/week	Demo moments, founder story, brand aesthetic
Long-form (HN/dev.to/YouTube)	1–2×/month	"How the agent works" deep dives
Community (Discord/Reddit)	Ongoing, value-first	Helpful presence, no spam
Product Hunt	One launch	Coordinated with portal readiness

- **Funnel:** content → **waitlist signup** → invite wave → **activation** (passkey + first agent/tokenized action).
- **Metrics that matter:** waitlist signups, **referral coefficient (K)**, demo-clip reach/saves, activation rate, and qualitative dev-community signal. Keep it lightweight; optimize the loop, not vanity counts.
- **Guardrail: all** claims route past the §7.1 vocabulary gate before publishing.

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8 8. The go-live timeline (corporate + compliance + marketing)

Mirrors the `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` §10 90-day cadence, extended with the two-entity formation, the gift, the MSA, the equity framework, and the marketing ramp. Order matters — note the dependencies.

Days 1–14 — exist as the structure

1. Clear the names (Wyoming name check + USPTO knockout for the brand).
2. File **both LLCs** — IP HoldCo (WY, manager-managed) + Management Co (home state).

3. Get **EINs** for both.
4. Adopt both **operating agreements** (HoldCo manager-managed: you = manager).
5. Execute the **IP / Technology Assignment** into the IP HoldCo *(must precede the gift)*.
6. **Gift the IP HoldCo to your child** (Assignment of Membership Interest) + capture Form 709 posture with your CPA.

Days 15–45 — be controlled, bankable & papered 7. Sign the **Management Services Agreement** (Mgmt Co ↔ HoldCo). 8. Open the **Management Company** bank account (Mercury/Brex); keep books fully separate. 9. **Foreign-qualify** where you operate. 10. Engage a **startup CPA + fintech/securities attorney** — scope them specifically to the **gift + valuation/709**, the **management fee**, the **anonymity layer**, and the **equity framework**. 11. Stand up the **Equity Incentive Framework + reserved pool** (§6); template the advisor/co-founder docs and the 83(b) checklist.

Days 46–90 — launch posture + marketing ramp 12. Publish **ToS / Privacy / E-Sign / "not advice" disclaimers** before any signup. 13. Write the **AML/KYC policy**; name yourself compliance officer; wire **OFAC screening**. 14. File the **trademark**; confirm **BOI** status for both entities. 15. **Lock the Phase-A scope** (non-custodial / no customer funds) and tie into the `LAUNCH.md` go/no-go gate — this plan's corporate rows feed gate **B6** there. 16. **Start the guerrilla marketing ramp:** waitlist live, build-in-public cadence on X/IG, first demo clips — all through the §7.1 vocabulary gate.

> The engineering go/no-go gates (iOS verification, E2E green, Hedera testnet vs. mainnet KMS) are owned by `LAUNCH.md` §3–6 and are unchanged by this plan.

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9 9. Cost envelope & risk register

Year-1 cost (extends `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md`'s appendix)

Line	Estimate
(all of `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md`'s Year-1 LLC/agent/legal/CPA/ToS lines)	~$5–18k
Second LLC (Management Co) formation + home-state fees	$100–500 + annual
Management Services Agreement drafting	$0.5–2k
Gift: valuation memo + Form 709 prep (CPA)	$0.5–3k
Equity plan (profits-interest framework + templates)	$1–4k
Optional anonymity wrapper (trust / child holding-LLC)	$0.5–3k
Added realistic Year-1	**~$2.5–12.5k on top of the base**

Still a small fraction of Phase-C licensing ($50–150k+ for MTLs) — the lean-now logic holds.

Risk register ⚖️

Risk	What goes wrong	Mitigation / owner
Gift-tax / valuation	Over-valued gift burns exemption or triggers tax; under-documented gift is challenged	Gift pre-revenue; CPA valuation memo + Form 709 (§4) — **CPA**
Management fee not respected	IRS recharacterizes an arbitrary/inflated fee; structure ignored	Arm's-length, documented, regularly invoiced fee; separate books (§3.2) — **CPA/Counsel**
Pierced liability shield	Commingling the two entities' funds collapses the separation	Separate accounts, observe formalities, never commingle — **You**
"Bank" naming trap	Marketing implies a charter → cease-and-desist	§7.1 vocabulary gate on every post — **Product/Legal**
83(b) missed	A grant recipient owes tax on vesting; unfixable	30-day checklist on every vesting grant (§6) — **Counsel**
Anonymity vs. fundability	Investors/banks require ownership disclosure at conversion	Accept privacy = public-record only; plan disclosure at the C-corp raise (§2.3) — **You/Counsel**
Co-founder converts LLC to partnership	Tax treatment changes on adding a member	Consider early C-corp conversion when adding a co-founder (§6.2) — **Counsel**

Companion documents: `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` (the entity ramp + Phase A/B/C compliance ladder this plan sits inside), `LAUNCH.md` (the launch readiness / go-no-go gate this plan's corporate rows feed), and `PRODUCTION-STRATEGY.md` (cloud, ops, and the GTM positioning §7 builds on).